

Vehicle Registration

When surrendering an out-of-state driver license, a new Texas resident must submit, with a driver license application, evidence that each motor vehicle owned by the person is currently registered in Texas, or indicate they do not own a motor vehicle required to be registered. A registration receipt issued by the county tax assessor-collector of the county in which the new resident resides is satisfactory evidence that your motor vehicle has been registered in Texas.

Fees

The required fee(s) must be submitted before any exams will be given for an original Texas driver license. An additional \$1 administrative fee is included in most transactions. However, if you are completing multiple transactions at the same time, in-person, by telephone or online, you will only be charged the \$1 administrative fee once. A \$1 administrative fee is not charged for transactions made through the mail.

For more information on all fees, refer to Appendix D of this handbook or visit our website, <https://www.dps.texas.gov/section/driver-license/driver-license-fees>.

Driver Education

Individuals younger than 25 years of age are required to successfully complete an approved driver education course. For more information on licensing requirements for applicants younger than 25 years of age, visit our website at www.dps.texas.gov/DriverLicense/ApplyforLicense.htm.

Impact Texas Drivers (ITD)

All driver license applicants must complete the Impact Texas Drivers (ITD) course appropriate for their age group prior to taking the driving exam. For more information, visit the ITD website, <https://impacttexasdrivers.dps.texas.gov>.

Minors

If you are younger than 18 years of age, your application must be signed, under oath, by the parent or guardian with custody. If there is not a guardian, your employer or county judge may sign the application. The person who signs may ask DPS to cancel your license any time before your 18th birthday. This request must be in writing and sworn to before an officer authorized to administer oaths. In addition, the minor applicant and cosigner must acknowledge receipt of information that provides information about distracted driving and explains the zero tolerance law. *See Chapter 10: Alcohol and Drugs Impact on the Driving Ability* for more information.

Examinations

Before any exams are given, you must pay the required fee. Your picture will be taken and you will be given a payment receipt. If you do not pass the knowledge and driving exams on your first attempt, your application will be held for 90 days. After 90 days or three failed exams, a new application and fee will be required.

The knowledge and driving exams are not required for applicants 18 years of age and older who surrender a valid out-of-state license. After you have passed all applicable exams, you will be issued a temporary license, which you may use for 45 days or until you receive your permanent license in the mail. If you do not receive your license in 45 days, email our customer service center at https://www.dps.texas.gov/DriverLicense/customer_service/Other.aspx.

Part 1: The Knowledge exam

As part of the *Less Tears More Years Act*, all applicants younger than 25 years of age are required to take a driver education course to apply for a driver license. Upon successful completion of certain courses, the person is not required to take the Class C knowledge exam, also known as the written exam, at the driver license office.

There are three types of knowledge exams.

1. Class C – Knowledge exam for all original applicants
2. Class M – Motorcycle knowledge exam. This exam is waived for applicants who successfully complete a state approved motorcycle operator training course and present proof of completion.
3. Class A or Class B – Rules exam for operators of Class A and Class B vehicles

You must score a grade of 70 percent or better to pass any knowledge exam.

Part 2: The Vision Examination

Your vision will be examined when you are at the driver license office. Depending on the results, you may be required to wear corrective lenses while driving if the lenses improve your vision and help increase the safety of your driving. If the results are inconclusive, you may be referred to your doctor.

